

LED

Short for "light-emitting diode." An LED is an electronic component that lights up when an electric current flows through it.

MASS

A measure of the amount of matter in an object.

MATTER

The name used for the materials that make up the universe.

MICROORGANISM

Any microscopic thing that is alive, such as bacteria.

MINERAL

A natural material, normally found underground. There are hundreds of different types. Rocks are made of minerals.

MIXTURE

A substance made of two or more compounds or elements.

MOLECULE

Two or more atoms held together by bonds.

NEUTRON

A tiny particle in an atom that contains no electric charge.

NON-NEWTONIAN FLUID

A liquid that can change its form and behavior depending upon the forces applied to it.

ORBIT

The path of a planet, comet, or asteroid through space around the sun, or the path of a moon around a planet. Gravity keeps objects in orbit.

OXYGEN

An element. One of the gases in air; essential for most of the life on Earth.

PHOTOSYNTHESIS

The process by which green plants make food from carbon dioxide and water using the energy of the sun.

PHOTOTROPISM

The way a plant turns and bends toward the sunlight.

PRESSURE

A force applied to a surface, particularly by gases or liquids.

PROTEIN

A particular type of compound essential to life. Proteins make up skin and hair, and also carry out all sorts of functions that keep you alive.

PROTON

A tiny particle in an atom that carries a positive electric charge.

REPULSION

A force that pushes things away from each other.

SOLUTION

A mixture of two chemicals, normally a solid dissolved into a liquid.

STALACTITE

An icicle-like structure hanging from a cave roof, formed gradually from minerals deposited by dripping water.

STALAGMITE

A column rising from the floor of a cave, formed gradually from minerals deposited by dripping water.

STATIC ELECTRICITY

The buildup of electric charge on an object that has lost or gained electrons.

STREAMLINED

An object shaped in a way that offers very little resistance to the flow of liquid or gas.

SUGAR

One of many sweet-tasting compounds, such as glucose.

SURFACE TENSION

A force that pulls the surface of a liquid tight. It is the result of attraction between atoms or molecules.

TENSION

A pulling force, such as that exerted by the steel cables used in parts of buildings or bridges.

TRANSPIRATION

The movement of water through the tubes in a plant's stem and leaves and its evaporation as vapor through tiny holes in the leaves.

ULTRAVIOLET RADIATION (UV)

A form of radiation. A type of light that's invisible to human eyes.

VAPOR

A gas that easily changes into a liquid if it is cooled or put under pressure.

VIRUS

A nonliving microscopic particle, smaller than a cell. Viruses reproduce by invading living cells, and can cause illness.

VISCOSITY

The resistance of a liquid to changing shape. A thick, sticky substance like honey flows slowly because it has a high viscosity.

VOLTAGE

A measure of the force that pushes electrons around a circuit.

VOLUME

The size of a three-dimensional space occupied by something or enclosing something.